

ENG-W 171: Digital Literacy & Composition (Spring 2026)

Audacious Women

Mon, Wed, Fri: 1:55 PM–2:45 PM
Ballantine Hall (BH) 015

Instructor: Shataparni Bhattacharya**Office Hours:** Mon, Wed: 3:00–4:00 PM**Office Hours Location:** Ballantine Hall (BH) 436**Email:** shabhat@iu.edu**Course Schedule**

Date	Readings/Assignments
Unit 0	
Week 1	
Mon. 1/12	Syllabus, course policies, attendance policies, office hours info
Wed. 1/14	- In Class - Introductions - Setting expectations & learning outcomes - What is most important to you in this class? What are your key values, needs, and questions?
Fri. 1/16	- In Class - Adobe basics - How to close read
Week 2	
Mon. 1/19	MLK Day; No class!
Wed. 1/21	- Review before class and come prepared to discuss: - Listen to this podcast episode by The Retrospectors: Britain's First Actresses (Dec 07, 2025) (about 10 mins) - Watch this video by the YouTube channel, History's Forgotten People: The Outrageous Mistress of Charles II's Court Nell Gwyn Pretty, Witty Nell (Dec 03, 2023) (about 22 mins) - See the announcement or Week 2 Modules for guiding questions to keep in mind while listening/watching

Fri. 1/23	- Read: <i>Writing Analytically (WA)</i>, pp. 2-16. <i>WA</i>, pp. 18-19. - In Class: - Introduction to Analysis Hogarth, A Just View (1724) Playbill of Troilus & Cressida (1679)
Unit 1	
Week 3	
Mon. 1/26	- Read before class: "The Five Analytical Moves" in <i>WA</i>, pp. 22-43 - In Class: - Notice Focus & Rank - The Method - Due by 11:59 PM: - Practicing the Method on a Portrait of Nell Gwynn
Wed. 1/28	- Read before class: - Paula Maust, "Notorious Strumpets on the English Restoration Stage" <i>WA</i>, pp. 45-50 <i>WA</i>, pp. 54-63 Reading Comprehension Tips & Annotating Texts
Fri. 1/30	- Due before class: 1/30 Reading Annotation 1 (Bush-Bailey) - Read before class: - Gilli Bush-Bailey, Introduction in <i>Treading the Bawds</i> (2006), pp. 1-17.
Week 4	
Mon. 2/2	- Read before class: - Wilhoit, "Summary" - Losh et al., "The Paragraph as a Sandwich" "The Six Parts of Argumentative Writing" "Says v. Does" "How to Write a Summary" "Sample Summary Diagram"
Wed. 2/4	- Read before class: - Working with Criticism

Fri. 2/6	- In Class: - How to do MLA style citations (see Purdue OWL) - Finish discussing Bush-Bailey - Due by 11:59 PM: - Minor Assignment 1: Summary
Week 5	
Mon. 2/9	- In Class: - Discuss Major Assignment 1
Wed. 2/11	- In Class: - Visual Rhetoric - Learning to make posters on Adobe - Due by <u>11:59 PM</u>: - Working Poster of Major Assignment 1
Fri. 2/13	- In class: - Translating scholarship into a visual medium - Due: - Essay Draft of Major Assignment 1, by <u>Friday (2/13) 11:59 PM</u> - MLA Citation Practice Quiz, by <u>Sunday (2/15) 11:59 PM</u>
Week 6	
Mon. 2/16	- In Class - Class visit from Writing Tutorial Services - Thesis Statements - Due by end of class: 2/16 Engagement - group work on fixing weak thesis statements
Wed. 2/18	- In Class: - Peer Review of Major Assignment 1
Fri. 2/20	- Read before class: Close reading literature Katherine Philips, "To My Excellent Lucasia, on Our Friendship" (1651-1652) - poem Anne Bradstreet, "The Author to Her Book" (1678) - poem Anne Finch, "The Introduction" (1713?) - poem - In Class: - Discuss readings for coming Monday (2/23) - Discuss Minor Assignment 2 - Close Reading webpage - Due by 11:59 PM: - Major Assignment 1: Poster + Essay

Unit 2	
Week 7	
This week, we'll tackle the following primary texts in preparation for Minor Assignment 2. Read: • Close reading literature • Katherine Philips, "To My Excellent Lucasia, on Our Friendship" (1651-1652) • Anne Bradstreet, "The Author to Her Book" (1678) • Anne Finch, "The Introduction" (1713?) • Aphra Behn, prefatory materials to <i>The Feigned Curtizans</i> (1679) - the dedication to Nell Gwynn (pages 2-4 of the PDF, ending right before the section titled "Prologue") • Delarivier Manley, prefatory materials to <i>The Royal Mischief</i> (1696) - (only read from "To the Reader" on page 3 of the PDF up to the section that ends right before "Prologue" on page 4) • Robert Gould, "The Playhouse. A Satyr" (1689) - read the whole poem for the gist, but only focus on about 10-12 lines to do a close reading • Anon., prefatory materials to <i>The Female Wits</i> (1704) - read up to the end of the <i>dramatis personae</i> (until the start of Act 1)	
Mon. 2/23	• In class: ◦ Discuss Philips, Bradstreet, and Finch ◦ Discuss Minor Assignment 2 - Close Reading webpage
Wed. 2/25	• In class ◦ Discuss Behn and Manley
Fri. 2/27	• In Class: ◦ Discuss Gould and <i>The Female Wits</i> • Due by <u>Sunday 3/1</u>: ◦ Respond to Discussion Board: Close-Reading Checkpoint for Minor 2
Week 8	
Mon. 3/2	• In Class: ◦ Learning how to make a webpage • Due by <u>Tuesday 3/3</u>: ◦ Minor Assignment 2 - Close Reading Webpage
Wed. 3/4	• NO CLASS - SB AWAY • Use our class time to read/watch and complete Comparative Analysis & Thesis Statements • Due by 2:45 PM: • 3/4 Engagement (Comparative Analysis & Thesis Statements)

Fri. 3/6	- In Class: - Discuss Major Assignment 2: Podcast - Rhetoric of Speech and Sound
Week 9	
Mon. 3/9	- In Class: - Learning to make a podcast using Adobe Audition - Due by Tuesday, 11:59 PM: - Written draft ("script") of Major Assignment 2
Wed. 3/11	- In Class: - Continue working on podcast
Fri. 3/13	NO CLASS - SPRING BREAK - Due at 11:59 PM by Sunday, 3/15: - Major Assignment 2
Sun. 3/15	<u>LAST DAY TO WITHDRAW WITH AN AUTOMATIC "W"</u> - Consider meeting with your advisor and withdrawing by this date if: - Your attendance percentage is below 80% - You have missed more than four classes so far - Your overall grade is below a C
Spring Break: NO CLASS (3/14 - 3/22)	
Unit 3	
Week 10	
Mon. 3/23	- Due before class: 3/23 Reading Annotation 2 (Orgel) - Read before class: - Stephen Orgel, "Nobody's Perfect: Or Why Did the English Stage Take Boys for Women?" (pp. 7-17) - Tools for textual analysis - In class: - Start discussing Orgel

Wed. 3/25	• Watch before class: ◦ "Judith Butler's Theory of Gender Performativity, Explained" by Film & Media Studies (Dec 19, 2020) ◦ "Judith Butler's Gender Performativity, Part 2: What is 'Performativity'?", by Film & Media Studies (Nov 1, 2021) • Read before class: ◦ Stephen Orgel, "Nobody's Perfect: Or Why Did the English Stage Take Boys for Women?" (pp. 17-27) • Due by 11:59 PM: ◦ 3/25 Orgel "Nobody's Perfect" - discussion
Fri. 3/27	• Due before class (try to finish by Thursday night): ◦ 3/27 Reading Annotation 3 (Roach) • Read before class: ◦ Joseph Roach, "Public Intimacy: The Prior History of 'It'" (2005), pp. 15-30. • Due by end of day: ◦ 3/27 - Criticism (using Roach)
Over the weekend	• Read: ◦ WA 63-68, "Apply a Reading as a Lens" ◦ WA 222-25, "Strategy 4: Use Your Sources to Ask Questions, Not Just to Provide Answers" ◦ WA 82-83, "Seems to Be about X, but Could Also Be... about Y" • Watch: ◦ Stage Beauty (2004). Class discussion on Monday. • Quiz due by 11:59 PM ◦ Tools for Filmic Analysis - quiz
Week 11	
Mon. 3/30	• In Class: ◦ Discuss <i>Stage Beauty</i> in reference to Bush-Bailey, Orgel, Roach. ◦ Sources as Lens for film analysis ◦ The X/Y thesis ◦ Discuss Minor Assignment 3
Wed. 4/1	• Read before class: ◦ Writing about film • Review the following examples of film reviews in magazines: ◦ Justin Chang, review of "Frankenstein" in the New Yorker (October 2025) ◦ Richard Brody, review of "Anora" in the New Yorker (October 2024)

Fri. 4/3	- Read one of the following pieces on design (based on your group) before arriving to class: Group 1: Color Rule Group 2: Dieter Rams' Ten Principles Group 3: Create for How People Feel Group 4: Write for How People Read Group 5: Using Plain Language Group 6: User Experience Hierarchy of Needs - In Class: - Concepts of Design - Learning to make magazine spreads on Adobe InDesign - Due by end of class: 4/3 Engagement - Creating a magazine spread
Week 12	
Mon. 4/6	- In Class: - Workday for Minor 3 - Due by 11:59 PM: - Minor Assignment 3
Wed. 4/8	- In Class: - Discuss Major Assignment 3 - Research Video - Source-as-Lens - X/Y Thesis - Evolving thesis
Fri. 4/10	- Read before class: - WA 327-336, "Six Strategies for Analyzing Sources" - WA 243-251, "Making a Thesis Evolve" - Watch before class: - X/Y Thesis and Comparative Analysis - Comparative Analysis & Thesis Statements - In Class: - Library and Database Research with IU Libraries research desk representative - Due by Sunday (4/12), 11:59 PM: - Written research plan for Major Assignment 3 (Inquiry question + working thesis + annotated bibliography)
Week 13	
Mon. 4/13	- In Class: - Complete Major 3 Worksheet
Wed. 4/15	<u>Optional Attendance</u> - Workday for Major 3 + SB available for extended Office Hours!

Fri. 4/17	- Review the following examples of researched video essays: "Dracula's Paprika Hendl from Bram Stoker's 1897 Novel" - Tasting History with Max Miller (October 21, 2025) - Due by end of class: - Peer review of Major Assignment 3 - Due by Saturday 11:59 PM: - Major assignment 3
Unit 4	
Week 14	
Mon. 4/20	- Read before class: - Saidiya Hartman, "A Note on Method" in <i>Wayward Lives, Beautiful Experiments</i> (W.W. Norton & Co., 2019), pp. xiii-xv. - Due by Tuesday (4/21) 11:59 PM: 4/20 Comparing Hartman to Bush-Bailey/ Orgel/ Roach
Wed. 4/22	<u>Visit to the Eskenazi Art Museum</u>
Fri. 4/24	- Review digital exhibition / remediated art history project: How to be a Guerrilla Girl" - Getty Museum "Inside the Guerrilla Girls' Collective Practice" - Due by Sunday (4/25) 11:59 PM: - Minor Assignment 4 (Artifacts Exhibition Pitch)
Week 15	
Mon. 4/27	- In Class: - Final portfolio discussion - OCQs
Wed. 4/29	<u>Optional Attendance</u> - Workday for Final Portfolio + SB available for extended Office Hours!
Fri. 5/1	- In Class - Final doubts, questions, thoughts - Complete "Permission to Use Work in Future Semesters" - Due by 11:59 PM: - Final Portfolio
CONGRATULATIONS! YOU DID IT! 😊	